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The Foreign and the Female in Arthur Conan Doyle: Beneath the Candy Coating

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IMPERIALISM AND THE WOMAN QUESTION, key elements in the cultural construct of late-Victorian England, intersect in the fiction of Sir Arthur Conan Doyle. Routinely, Conan Doyle depicts subjects from nations other than England, subjects who are female, dangerous, undesirable, even murderous. Knighted for his patriotic polemics on the Boer War, Conan Doyle believed in the relevance of politics to fiction. He said that "the age of fiction is coming—the age when religious and social and political changes will all be effected by means of the novelist.... To get an idea to penetrate to the masses of the people, you must put fiction around it, like sugar round a pill."[1] In his fiction Conan Doyle's "othering" of the foreign and the female is evident in his construction of character traits and placement of subjects in plot positions. He presents heroes and villains in ways that assert the eminence of the English over the Other-than-English and the Male over the Other-than-male.

In "The Speckled Band," Conan Doyle traits a murderer with trappings of the Far East, creating a villain from afar who preys on innocent English citizens. In *The Parasite* he constructs a mesmerist as female, West Indian, and spiritually parasitic; she preys on English men in a small college town. In *Lot No. 249* he creates a deadly confrontation between "a scientific student" and a neighbor who, being expert in Eastern languages and Egyptian artifacts, has brought a mummy back to life. In various Sherlock Holmes stories featuring female subjects, Conan Doyle devises plots that depend upon women who, despite being vital to the narrative, are nevertheless silent and, except for occasional scenes, are physically absent. Like colonized foreign subjects, females are controlled, contained, and marginalized. In these stories, the villains' out-

comes are death, the females' fate are containment, and the English male heroes reassert the power of reason, patriarchy, and Empire.

Conan Doyle's own favorite Holmes story, "The Adventure of the Speckled Band,"[2] vividly demonstrates fiction's powers of vilifying the foreign. Holmes investigates threats to the life of his client Helen Stoner[3] and decides on two suspects, each characterized as foreign and threatening. The first is a band of gypsies living on the property of Helen's family manor, where she lives with her stepfather, Dr. Grimesby Roylott. Roylott himself is Holmes's other suspect, and the evil in him stems from his connection with the East. He lived for some time in Calcutta; he keeps dangerous Indian animals as pets; he uses a murder weapon that originates in India; and he is wearing Turkish slippers when he attempts the murder of Helen and afterwards dies.

These details of "The Speckled Band" form a network of imperialist ideas and assumptions that infiltrates the construction of Holmes as hero and Roylott as villain. And while readers enjoy this "grim snake story," to use Conan Doyle's own phrase,[4] they are at the same time availing themselves of the author's imperialist views. Conan Doyle believed that "in time. . . . the Anglo-Saxon will swing the sword of justice over the whole world,"[5] and he demonstrates his vision in "The Speckled Band" and other stories. Holmes is the hero while Roylott is the villain, and Holmes is pure English while Roylott is tainted by the East.

The strongest evidence in "The Speckled Band" of Conan Doyle's imperialist views is his characterization of Roylott. While certain traits are classically villainesque, such as the quick, hot temper and the brutal strength, other elements are clearly Eastern, and while these Eastern elements are not inherently evil, they take on an aura of evil when combined with Roylott's temper and violence. Holmes states that "the idea of using a form of poison which could not possibly be discovered by any chemical test was just such a one as would occur to a clever and ruthless man who had had an Eastern training."[6] Additionally, Roylott's murder weapon is found only in India: the Indian swamp adder.[7] Besides his choice of murder weapon, Roylott's preference for "red heelless Turkish slippers," his "passion . . . for Indian animals," his preference for "strong Indian cigars," and his friendship with "the wandering gipsies" all work together to establish him as distinctively foreign in character, habit, and action.[8]

Roylott serves to suggest that the Other might be an Englishman who has been irreparably altered by the Other. Roylott is an Englishman whose "family was at one time among the richest in England." While Roylott was in India practicing medicine, his "hereditary" "violence of temper approaching to mania . . . [was] intensified by his long residence in the tropics." In a fit of temper, he "beat his native butler to death" and, after imprisonment in India, he "returned to England a morose and disappointed man." In effect, India brought out the worst in Roylott and propelled him back to England to wreak havoc there. Back in England, after "a series of disgraceful brawls took place, two of which ended in the police-court . . . [Roylott] became the terror of the village."[9] His only friends are the gypsies he permits to wander his estate.

While Roylott's Indian connections are implicitly the source of his evil, they are also the cause of his own death. The smell of his strong Indian cigar wafting through the ventilator into Helen's bedroom alerts Holmes to the connecting air shaft. Holmes arranges with Helen to slip secretly into her room after dark and wait for Roylott to make his move. When Roylott sends his swamp adder through the air shaft and down the fake bell pull in Helen's room, Holmes is waiting; he strikes at the snake with a cane. The frenzied snake shoots back through the vent and bites Roylott instead, killing him with his own murder weapon.

Holmes simply shrugs off his own involvement in Roylott's death. As he and Watson travel home to Baker Street the next day he tells Watson, "I am no doubt indirectly responsible for Dr. Grimesby Roylott's death, and I cannot say that it is likely to weigh very heavily upon my conscience."[10] In Holmes's eyes—indeed, in many readers' eyes by this point—Roylott deserved to die.

Conan Doyle's construction of the women in "Charles Augustus Milverton," "The Greek Interpreter," and "The Dancing Men" illustrates how a society's patriarchal ideology infiltrates its fiction with results similar to those of imperialism. "Charles Augustus Milverton" features a blackmailer named Milverton, the women he blackmails, and Holmes, who investigates the case of Eva Blackwell. The plot centers on three female characters: Eva Blackwell, an unnamed woman who shoots Milverton, and Milverton's housemaid Agatha. The first of these women, Eva Blackwell, is Holmes's client and presumably the focal subject of this mystery; nevertheless, Lady Blackwell remains physically absent from events; we simply hear *about* her from Watson. The second female,

the mystery murderer, enters the story only briefly but is nevertheless indispensable: while Holmes and Watson are hiding in Milverton's study, interrupted in their clandestine search by the arrival of Milverton himself, the mystery woman enters, shoots Milverton, and disappears. She remains silent as well as nameless and does not surface again. The third woman also remains silent. She is Milverton's housemaid, and Holmes proposes marriage to her to gain her confidence and thus her knowledge of Milverton's house and routine. Between the three women the case is opened *and* shut; Holmes's contribution is simply to drop Milverton's blackmail files into the burning fireplace as he flees the scene of the crime.

A similar case is "The Greek Interpreter." Again the plot depends on a female who is relegated to the narrative's margins. Only once does Sophy appear in person, and even then indirectly as part of the account of events told to Holmes by the man who interprets Greek. Moreover, the image of Sophy he conveys is vague; he says, "I could not see her clearly enough to know more than that she was tall and graceful, with black hair, and clad in some sort of loose white gown."[11] Sophy utters one broken sentence and is gone. She is known to readers third-hand, for the information passes from the Greek interpreter to Holmes and Watson and then from Watson to his readers. We eventually learn that Sophy, who is Greek, has caused the crisis at hand by running away from home with an Englishman. Her brother follows her to England and is captured by Sophy's boyfriend, and the Greek interpreter is brought in to translate negotiations between boyfriend and brother over Sophy's property. During this meeting, Sophy bursts upon the scene and then immediately is dragged away. While appearing in the action only briefly, Sophy is nevertheless the sole cause of events.

This pattern of backgrounding female subjects recurs in "The Dancing Men." Holmes must solve a life-or-death puzzle stemming from the mysterious past of a woman named Elsie. Elsie's husband (note that the active subject position has already shifted to the husband) has noticed chalk drawings of little dancing stick-figure men on the doors and window ledges of their house. Elsie, he presumes, can read these hieroglyphics but refuses to admit it, much less read them to him. Convinced his life is in danger, Elsie's husband reports to Holmes what Elsie has said and done so far, which amounts only to refusals to discuss the hieroglyphics. This is as close to Elsie as the reader gets, for by the time Holmes and Watson travel to the couple's estate, Elsie has suffered a gunshot wound

and remains unconscious and therefore speechless for the remainder of the narrative. Elsie is never actively or verbally present in the story, although like Sophy, she is the cause of the events.[12]

When Conan Doyle does place a female subject actively and vocally in the forefront of a narrative, the woman is nevertheless subjugated to male characters by her potentially harmful or morally bankrupt nature. Women are clearly traited as potentially harmful in "A Scandal in Bohemia," in which we learn that Holmes unrelentingly refuses to become seriously involved, romantically or otherwise, with any woman because, as Watson explains, "for the trained reasoner to admit such intrusions into his own delicate and finely adjusted temperament was to introduce a distracting factor which might throw a doubt upon all his mental results."[13] In this famous story Irene Adler outwits Sherlock Holmes and escapes the country with the very photograph he was hired to procure. Watson tells us that Holmes is lucky to be rid of her destructive feminine influence, the cause of so much grit in the well-oiled wheels of male intelligence. "Grit in a sensitive instrument," Watson writes, "or a crack in one of [Holmes's] own high-power lenses, would not be more disturbing than a strong emotion in a nature such as his."[14] And while Holmes remembers Irene with dubious affection as not just any woman but *the* woman, the one who outwitted him, he nevertheless maintains an "aversion to women."[15] Women and their accompanying emotions are a "distracting factor" to male powers of reason and deduction; indeed, "all emotions . . . were abhorrent to his cold, precise, but admirably balanced mind."[16]

An examination of *The Parasite* (1894),[17] a novella about a mesmerist who spiritually attaches herself to her subjects like a parasite, vividly illustrates the parallel between women and the colonized Other. The tension between the main characters, Austin Gilroy and Helen Penclosa, symbolizes the tension between England and her colonized countries.

Austin Gilroy is a young English science professor, and Helen Penclosa is a mesmerist from the West Indies. Throughout the narrative, Conan Doyle traits Gilroy as scrupulously rational and familiarly English while Helen, the outsider, is a dark and alien "Other," a foreign source of evil and power that intrudes on the domestic security of Gilroy and his fiancée, Agatha. Gilroy is a physiology professor who, in seeking scientific evidence of the process and effects of mesmerism, submits to

hypnotism by Helen. At first, Gilroy is impressed by her abilities and records in his journal: "My horizon of scientific possibilities has suddenly been enormously extended."[18] Since readers learn the events of the narrative through Gilroy's journal entries, they experience those events from Gilroy's perspective; like Elsie, who exists second-hand through her husband's narration, Helen exists second-hand through Gilroy's journal.

And like the East, which brought out Roylott's evil nature, Helen brings out the worst in Gilroy. Gilroy soon realizes that Helen "has conceived a passion for me" and worse, that she "has a parasite soul." He realizes too that "she rouses something in me—something evil—something I had rather not think of. She paralyzes my better nature, too, at the moment when she stimulates my worse." Uncontrollably, however, Gilroy is continually drawn to Helen until the moment of her death. At several points he attempts to break off contact with her; he relies on his scientific training, saying "I must pit my intellect against her powers."[19] Helen vengefully counters by causing him to perform embarrassing and harmful actions while under hypnosis; Gilroy delivers absurd lectures and loses his professorship, he attempts to rob a branch of the Bank of England, and he beats up a fellow professor. Gilroy's final action under Helen's power is curtailed by the woman's death, at the moment of which Gilroy awakens from a trance to find himself in his fiancée's boudoir preparing to throw acid on her.

Creating a protagonist such as Gilroy accomplishes at least two things. Conan Doyle is writing the story just one year after the supposed death of Sherlock Holmes, his most popular character, in "The Adventure of the Final Problem" (1893). While "killing" Holmes was Conan Doyle's own idea, his reading public was so dissatisfied and angry that, in creating Professor Gilroy, he may have been attempting to pacify readers with a Holmes substitute complete with rational, scientifically driven motivations and desires.

But Conan Doyle is doing much more with *The Parasite* than simply responding to his readers' desire for a Holmesian hero. Critics such as Stephen Knight have argued that a nation's attitudes, fears, and hopes often surface in its popular culture.[20] In popular fiction like Conan Doyle's, heroes like Austin Gilroy and Sherlock Holmes provide hope by functioning as a means of controlling those fears, and they do so through the logical, fact-based pursuit of knowledge from observable data. Gilroy

asserts that "A departure from pure reason affects me like an evil smell or a musical discord."[21] Both Gilroy and Holmes rely on scientific data to form conclusions about the dangers they face. In writing stories such as these in which the hero is rational and scientific, and the villain is emotion-driven (that is, irrational) and non-scientific, Conan Doyle is expressing personifications of his own familiar England and the less familiar colonized nations. Moreover, male subjects possess the scientific traits and female subjects possess the emotional traits; these scientifically rational men ultimately control and/or contain the irrational women.

During the course of *The Parasite*, Gilroy battles to maintain control of himself against the parasitic Helen, who seeks to "possess" him by gaining control of his unconscious impulses. Gilroy feels her alien presence within him as "a peculiar double consciousness." Helen's is "the predominant *alien will* which was bent upon drawing me to the side of its owner, and there was the feebler protesting personality, which I recognized as being myself."[22] Elsewhere Gilroy calls Helen a "devil woman."[23] By representing Helen in this devouring, demonizing way, Conan Doyle reveals his own cultural and racial prejudices and stereotypical conceptions of foreigners and in this case West Indians in particular. In addition, he reasserts the primacy of the familiar and rational over the suspect nature of the foreign and irrational.

The conflict between Gilroy and Helen being a power struggle, it is not surprising that Helen's power should be represented in predator imagery. Helen brings out a "brutal primitive instinct" in Gilroy,[24] and he refers to her regularly as "the creature." She is characterized three times as a tiger and twice as a snake. When Gilroy makes a mental effort to resist Helen's will and power, he nevertheless feels pulled to her like prey in the grasp of a predator. After Helen, from across town, uses her hypnotic hold on Gilroy's mind to induce him to come to her, Gilroy writes in his journal: "Suddenly I was gripped—gripped and dragged from the couch. It is only thus that I can describe the overpowering nature of the force *which pounced upon me*."[25]

Conan Doyle expresses the power struggles between Gilroy and Helen in war imagery that can suggest Britain's battles to acquire colonies. Helen directs the destructive activities of her hypnotized subjects much as "an engineer on the shore might guide a Brennan torpedo."[26] Also, when Gilroy stands up to Helen, he "*won his way to the front* by his

hard reasoning power and by his devotion to fact."[27] The professor's scientific, rational mind withstands the attack of Helen's power, at least for a time, and then further developments in the struggle unfold in terms of captivity, an extension of the war motif. Gilroy vows that "I must at all costs break this chain which holds me," and during a trance he realizes that "I am her slave, body and soul."[28]

Gilroy's experiences in resisting Helen's power give form to a new sort of threat from the colonized Other—the threat of power from afar. That is, a citizen of England cannot be sure of insulation from the colonized subjects even though there is a great distance between them. Like Penclosa, the Other may exercise its will across distances, dragging its prey to destruction. What, then, is to serve as protection against the Other? Gilroy's final, desperately formed decision is that he must kill Helen—exterminate the brute, if you will.

The Other is at fault for war and its consequences, whether that war be a figurative/intellectual war or a literal/physical war. While Gilroy knows that he himself has performed embarrassing and harmful actions, he concludes that Helen is to blame; she is the source of this evil. Gilroy writes with relief in his journal, "There is some consolation in the thought, then, that these odious impulses for which I have blamed myself do not really come from me at all. They are all transferred from her.... I feel cleaner and lighter for the thought."[29]

As with Roylott's death in "The Speckeld Band," Conan Doyle here achieves several key effects with Helen's death. While justifying the villain's demise and thereby satisfying readers' desire for justice, he subtly merges patriarchy and imperialism. Disturbingly, Conan Doyle does not resolve the tension of a parasitic Other maintaining control over a resistant English victim. Gilroy is ultimately unable to break free of Helen's power, and he is on his way to kill her when he learns that she has just died of an illness. Conan Doyle does not invite readers to perceive Helen's death as unfortunate or even sad but, on the contrary, as occurring in the nick of time. Patriarchy and imperialism perform a disturbing merger: the death of the Othered woman allows the Anglo male to live on in safety.

When Gilroy finally decided that he had to kill Penclosa to escape her power, he focused on her animal nature. "Murder!" he wrote in his journal. "It has an ugly sound. But you don't talk of murdering a snake or of murdering a tiger."[30] Gilroy reduced the Other to an animal state, a

condition he felt comfortable attacking, even killing. His adversary was no longer a person but an animal, a bestial threat to the domestic safety of himself and the other members of his collegiate English community. In Gilroy, Conan Doyle has characterized not only an *empiricist* hero of science and rationalism but also an *imperialist* hero of the British Empire.

Just as the threats of Roylott, with his Eastern training, and Helen Penclosa, with her alien will, are neutralized by the timely deaths of these villains, so is a threat from the East neutralized by another timely death in *Lot No. 249*. In this novella, a young medical student discovers that his downstairs neighbor has brought an Egyptian mummy back to life and is directing it to attack his enemies. Abercrombie Smith, the student of medicine, must pit his scientific intellect against Edward Bellingham, a student with an Eastern training. In the end, Smith forces Bellingham at gunpoint to hack up the mummy and burn the pieces along with the roll of papyrus containing the mummy's secrets. After performing this "public duty," Smith goes back to his medical studies. Bellingham retreats to Eastern locales and is "last heard of in the Sudan."[31]

Conan Doyle constructs Abercrombie Smith as studious, manly, dutiful, and above all, scientific. Like Sherlock Holmes, he smokes a pipe habitually, and like his creator Conan Doyle, he studies medicine. Taking shape from these traits is an English hero along the lines of Sherlock Holmes or Austin Gilroy, who will confront the threat of the Other with scientific cunning, deadly force, and reassuring finality. Smith is among those "men whose minds and tastes turned naturally to all that was manly and robust," and his apartment furnishings reveal his priorities: there lies "a litter of medical books upon the table, with scattered bones, models and anatomical plates," and to the side are stashed "a couple of singlesticks and a set of boxing gloves."[32] As well, Smith is "a famous runner,"[33] an accomplished oarsman, and soon-to-be medical doctor. "With his firm mouth, broad forehead and clear-cut, somewhat hard-featured face," he is the epitome of Victorian manliness, and being humble as well, he is "so dogged, so patient, and so strong that he might in the end overtop a more showy genius."[34] In short, Abercrombie Smith is a perfect specimen of English morality and heroism.

A sharp contrast, indeed, is Edward Bellingham, the man behind the mummy. His appearance, habits, and furnishings, too, reveal his na-

ture and suggest that he has more in common with the mummy than is possible without mystical intervention. In fact, Smith "had never seen nature's danger signals flying so plainly upon a man's countenance."[35] The Egyptologist is "very fat, but gave the impression of having at some time been considerably fatter, for his skin hung loosely in creases and folds, and was shot with a meshwork of wrinkles. Short stubbly brown hair bristled up from his scalp, with a pair of thick wrinkled ears protruding on either side."[36] Smith's close friend observes that "there's something damnable about him, something reptilian." Bellingham is an expert in Eastern studies and speaks fluently in a number of Eastern tongues—"he's a demon at them"—and can converse with Arabs "as if he had been born and nursed and weaned among them."[37] In his apartment, "walls and ceiling were thickly covered with a thousand strange relics from Egypt and the East," including weapons, statues of Eastern deities, and a stuffed crocodile from the Nile. While Smith's table is covered with medical paraphernalia, Bellingham's is "littered with papers, bottles, and the dried leaves of some graceful palmlike plant"—and a mummy.[38]

Just as the evil Helen Penclosa is compared to snakes and tigers, so is the Egyptian mummy, when brought to life, compared to apes and tigers. When the mummy attacks a student against whom Bellingham bears a grudge, he swings down from a tree, apelike, to strangle him with "beastly arms" that are "as strong and as thin as steel bands"; he afterwards escapes by "swinging himself over" a nearby wall. Rumors circulate that an ape must have escaped his trainer. Later, when the mummy pursues Smith down a dark countryside lane, he "was bounding like a tiger at his heels" and Smith escapes to say he had "been within handgrip of the devil."[39]

At first Smith views the idea of a mummy springing to life with "scientific contempt," but after the wild animal-like attacks on others and himself, he confronts Bellingham and warns him, "You'll find that your filthy Egyptian tricks won't answer in England."[40] And like Gilroy, who decides he must kill Helen to escape her parasitic powers, Smith determines that the only solution to the murderous mummy is to kill it, and he is willing to kill Bellingham in the process if necessary. He tells his close friend that murder "is quite on the cards. . . . There is only one course open to me, and I am determined to take it."[41] Smith gears up with a heavy revolver, a hunting crop, and the longest amputating knife he can procure and confronts Bellingham. He ensures that the mummy,

with its "spices and dried essences," and the papyrus containing the secret to bringing it to life, are all burned before his eyes. Finally, like Holmes who departs the scene of Roylott's death with an almost flippant attitude, Smith quits the scene of the mummy's incineration while saying to Bellingham, "And now, good morning, for I must go back to my studies."[42]

The implications of Conan Doyle's constructions of foreign and female subjects are not to be underestimated. The narratives communicate, via the villains, a "type" that tells the reader how to view foreigners. Women remain silent shadows with rare forays as villains into the foreground. As well, via the hero, the narrative presents a desirable type to which the reader can direct his or her admiration and desires of emulation. Moreover, the reader is likely to experience the narrative events through the (male) hero rather than through the villain or woman and thus tends to identify with, even take on attitudes of this hero. As Judith Fetterley has argued, narratives that foreground and value male subjects while minimizing or eliminating female subjects induce female readers to become not-female in order to step into the protagonist's shoes and experience the story completely. "In such fictions," she writes, "the female reader is co-opted into participation in an experience from which she is explicitly excluded; she is asked to identify with a selfhood that defines itself in opposition to her; she is required to identify against herself."[43] The same argument easily applies to non-Anglo readers of imperialist fiction; they, too, must identify against themselves. In this way, imperialist views (in the male hero) towards the foreign and the female were taught to the British public through popular fiction. The effects of these views on readers a century later, after history has recorded the decline of British imperialism and the rise of feminist criticism, would provide for a profitable study.

Notes

1. See Robert Barr, "A Dialogue Between Conan Doyle and Robert Barr, Recorded by Mr. Barr," *McClure's Magazine*, 3 (1894), 508.

2. See John A Hodgson, "Doyle's Favorite Sherlock Holmes Stories," *Sherlock Holmes: The Major Stories with Contemporary Critical Essays*, John A. Hodgson, ed. (Boston: Bedford Books of St Martin's Press, 1994), 435.

3. Hodgson troubles the issue of the Indian swamp adder, pointing out that no such animal exists and charging that the story therefore "criminally violat[es] the laws of its genre . . . [and] of realism itself." See Hodgson, "The Recoil of 'The Speckled Band'. Detective Story and Detective Discourse," *Sherlock Holmes: The Major Stories with Contemporary Critical Essays*, 337. Cait Murphy provides additional critique of the "nonexistent" swamp adder and its impossible capabilities See Murphy, "The Game's Still Afoot," *The Atlantic*, 259·3 (1987), 58–62 and 64–66.

4. See Hodgson, "Doyle's Favorite," 435

5. See Raymond Blathwayt, "A Talk with Conan Doyle," *Bookman* 50, (1897), 51.

6. See Arthur Conan Doyle, "The Adventure of the Speckled Band," *The Classic Illustrated Sherlock Holmes* (Stamford, CT: Longmeadow, 1987), 123

7. See Rosemary Hennessy and Rajeswari Mohan, "The Construction of Women in Three Popular Texts of Empire: Towards a Critique of Materialist Feminism," *Textual Practice* 3, (1989), 323-59. Hennessy and Mohan examine Helen Stoner in conjunction with female subjects in two other popular texts of the period, arguing that "The Speckled Band" "dramatizes the sexual economy of patriarchy· the equation of women and property" (324).

8. See Doyle, "Speckled Band," 121, 111, 110.

9. Ibid., 110

10. Ibid., 123.

11 See Arthur Conan Doyle, "The Adventure of the Greek Interpreter," *Classic Illustrated*, 298.

12 See Catherine Belsey, "Constructing the Subject: Deconstructing the Text," *Contemporary Literary Criticism: Literary and Cultural Studies*, 3rd ed. Robert Con Davis and Ronald Schleifer, ed. (New York: Longman, 1994), 355–70. Of great merit is her study of Elsie and the (sub)text of "The Dancing Men," performed from a feminist-Marxist perspective.

13. See Arthur Conan Doyle, "A Scandal in Bohemia," *Classic Illustrated*, 11

14. Ibid., 11.

15. See Arthur Conan Doyle, "Greek Interpreter," 293.

16. See Arthur Conan Doyle, "Scandal," 11.

17. Critical studies of *The Parasite* are few Worth reading is Stephen K. Knight, "The Case of the Great Detective," *Meanjin* 40.2 (1981), 175–85. This essay contains one paragraph on *The Parasite* and builds a case for Penclosa's symbolizing a threat against patriarchy.

18. See Arthur Conan Doyle, *The Parasite, The Horror of the Heights and Other Tales of Suspense* (San Francisco· Chronicle, 1992), 63.

19. Ibid., 70, 72

20. See Knight, 185.

21. See Arthur Conan Doyle, *Parasite*, 55.

22. Ibid., 76, emphasis added.

23. Ibid., 77.

24. Ibid., 69.

25 Ibid., 76, emphasis added.

26. Ibid., 62.

27. Ibid., 65, emphasis added.

28. Ibid., 73, 77.

29. Ibid., 72.

30. Ibid., 88.

31. See Arthur Conan Doyle, *Lot No. 249, Horror of the Heights*, 42, 46.

32. Ibid., 17, 18.

33. Ibid., 39.

34 Ibid., 20.

35. Ibid., 23.

36. Ibid., 22.

37. Ibid., 18.

38. Ibid., 22–23.

39. Ibid., 30, 39, 40.

40. Ibid., 30, 38.

41. Ibid., 43.

42. Ibid., 46.

43. See Judith Fetterley, *The Resisting Reader: A Feminist Approach to American Fiction* (Bloomington: Indiana University Press, 1978), xii.